



PHOTOS BY VISHAL GHAVRI

“AI will make things easier. But at the same time, it will change things quite dramatically in some sectors. And it is up to us to be able to decide how you plan for the changes”

business model... people might fail in some of the models... How do you deal with the culture of failures? Let's assume you take two-three great people in your organisation, say, 'Well go and test this idea. I'll give you two years; I'll give you X amount of money.' And guess what? Maybe they fail... How do you take that failure and learn from it? But more important, how do you make sure that the people who took the risks are welcomed back? **The risk management of failure, acceptance of failure becomes a very important part of creating a future. And that is something we are not very good at.** That's the challenge.

Q: If you're running a business, you probably want to know if AI is going to save costs. And if you are part of a business, you want to know, 'Am I going to lose my job?' Is AI going to cause job losses?

A: It will certainly make transitions in jobs more acute, sometimes more frequent. But AI is a long journey. And today AI is just the next phase in the digital transformation that we all are going through. So what do I think is going to happen? There are three axes of impact or change by AI. One axis is you can apply AI in what we're doing today, and get all the benefits of cost, quality, and time. To take a simple example, in finance or in banking, if you wanted to get your wealth managed professionally before, you had to have a certain wealth level to be able to afford the time of a professional banker or manager. Today all of that is handled by automated algorithms, AI-based systems, which do it much more cheaply for people with smaller volumes of wealth... That's taking things you're doing today and doing it better, cheaper, faster.

Then there's another important area, broadly termed consumerisation. And that is using technology to make the lives of the consumer simpler, easier, hassle-free and friendlier. And the best example of that is how we today interact with Netflix or Amazon or similar systems; we have got used to this ease of use of these systems. And that similar ease of use is something other sectors can learn from, whether it's healthcare, government services, banking, and so on. So making life simpler for customers and others is an early win we can focus on.

The much more challenging part is creating a new business model, which is really creating backwards. How do you create the new business models? How do you test them out? That's where you need a lot of new skills, you need a lot of new experimentations. **And I think combining all these three things, is an**